

“SIX LESSONS FROM AN UNJUST STEWARD”

Luke 16:1-8-12

Jesus is telling the story of a rich man whose business manager is dishonest. When the rich man discovers the dishonesty of his business manager he calls him in and lets him know he is about to be dismissed. When the business manager realizes he is about to be dismissed he comes up with a plan to provide for his own future. In verse three Jesus quotes him as saying ***“I do not have the strength to dig ditches, and I am too proud to beg.”*** The plan that he concocted was to bring each of the rich mans debtors in and offer to settle with them for half of their debt. By doing this he made friends with potential employers, thus guaranteeing his own employability... Verses 8-12 read like this... ***“The rich man had to admire the dishonest rascal for being so shrewd. And it is true that the citizens of this world are more shrewd than the godly are. (9) I tell you, use your worldly resources to benefit others and make friends. In this way, your generosity stores up a reward in heaven. (10) Unless you are faithful in small matters you won’t be faithful in large ones. If you cheat even a little, you won’t be honest with greater responsibilities. (11) If you are un-trustworthy with worldly wealth, who will trust you with the true riches of heaven? If you are not faithful with other peoples money, why should you be trusted with money of your own?”***

- 1) Use our worldly resources wisely... Use them to make friends... We make friends by helping others...
- 2) Generosity stores up riches in heaven... Some people think Heaven is going to be a place of complete equality... Our deeds determine what our eternity is going to be like...
- 3) If we cannot be faithful with a little we will not be entrusted with more...
- 4) If we cheat in small matters we will not have the opportunity to try our hand with larger responsibilities...
- 5) If God cannot trust us with worldly wealth He will not entrust us with spiritual matters...
- 6) If we cannot do what is right with the wealth of others why would god entrust us with money of our own?